

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 43

TENNESSEE

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Tennessee's family courts and child-welfare system.

138

TENNESSEE FAMILIES ON RECORD · 248 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 17 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
OCTOBER 23, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
60 OF 95

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · TENNESSEE

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Tennessee. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Magistrate Angela Blevins

JUDGE · KNOXVILLE · **6 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She ignored evidence contradicting dcs's alleged drug test she did not listen to my a&d assessor she labeled me as incredible for no reason She ignored a negative drug screen that was submitted by my attorney she deemed me uncredible because I didn't fill out custody papers correctly and kept my kids in custody and threatened me saying that my rights could be terminated and I needed to watch myself"* KNOX

> *"She would not let us testify in our own defense. And was making joking remarks about how there was no way we were getting our kids back. She is corrupt, an absolute deviant, and should be in prison - has no business medling with families' lives."* KNOX COUNTY JUVENILE COURT

> *"Magistrate Blevens combined Two separate cases to the detriment of my son, but for her own convenience. Magistrate Blevens removed my son from the home against protocol. There is definitely judicial Bias, in my opinion."* KNOX

> *"Signed the order to remove the girls, twice, without, cause, due process, or investigation"* KNOX COUNTY FAMILY COURT

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/tn-magistrate-angela-blevins/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Dianna Russell

JUDGE · SEVIER · **6 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Ordered removal of child across state lines for a custody case in a third state, I wasn't even served with the order but had to turn my daughter over by 7pm that day and I live 4 hours away from that court."*

> *"Committed perjury on motions and in hearings, Judge Rader threw her off the case only AFTER my attorney brought her misconduct to light, but the damage was done"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/tn-dianna-russell/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Darrell L. Scarlett

JUDGE · RUTHERFORD COUNTY · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Shortly presided after judge #2 recusal (Atwood). He was aware of corruption and refused to address it. He is also a judge mentioned in "Charlotte's Story" of the book Framed."* RUTHERFORD COUNTY CHANCERY COURT

> *"Ignored evidence, prolonged reunification which caused estrangement"*

> *"Denied a motion for a protective order"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/tn-darrell-l-scarlett/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Joseph "Woody" Woodruff

JUDGE · WILLIAMSON · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Made judgement without hearing any evidence. Referred to court cases that never occurred in his judgement. Failed to review actual evidence and investigative reports from child welfare and law enforcement and ignored exonerating evidence including audio recording of opposing party admission of guilt under oath."*

> *"Denied my motion without hearing, gender discrimination and bias. Abuse Discrimination and abuse"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/tn-joseph-woody-woodruff/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Lori Walker

ATTORNEY (OPPOSING) · SEVIER · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/tn-lori-walker/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Robert Huddleston'

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · SEVIER · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/tn-robert-huddleston/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

W. Scott Kimberly

ATTORNEY · RUTHERFORD COUNTY · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"He made several false allegations against me never proved anything or he would try to take something and twist it. He is very manipulative and conniving. I know that there was a court reporter in that room, but yet they are claiming that there wasn't."*

> *"Abusive litigator, tricky aggrements, files false documents and money hungry. Uses manipulation tactics by making a statement and then asking questions so you get trapped."*

> *"Plays golf with judges. Litigated while another state had jurisdiction and did not catch on until a few months and several thousands in."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/tn-w-scott-kimberly/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

TENNESSEE AT A GLANCE.

Across 138 Tennessee families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
248
138 of 138 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$83,375
median across 56 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
17
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
44.2%
61 of 138 who answered; 39 of 138 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTIES REPRESENTED
138	1.8	138 of 138	60

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Tennessee families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF TENNESSEE FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	75	$17,000	$47,045	$3,528,390
Lost Wages	70	$10,000	$61,231	$4,286,200
Other Court Fees	42	$500	$3,587	$150,650
Therapy / Evaluations	49	$2,000	$4,732	$231,867
Reunification Services	39	$860	$2,071	$80,755
GAL Fees	34	$1,250	$4,144	$140,900
Asset Loss [1]	54	$10,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (56 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	$83,375	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($10,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost	17	1.4 yrs
Mean months lost	30	2.5 yrs
Total across all families	2,982	248.5 yrs

04 WHO IS REPORTING · TENNESSEE

Most families documenting in Tennessee are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	74	54%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	15	11%
Case closed: within last 2 years	15	11%
Not provided	13	9%
Active case: progress being made	9	7%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS	72	52%
Family Court Only	43	31%
CPS Only	13	9%
Unknown	10	7%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	41	30%
5 – 10 years	22	16%
6 months – 1 year	21	15%
3 – 5 years	20	15%
Less than 6 months	17	12%

CUSTODY STATUS

Visitation Only	37	27%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access	37	27%
Children in Foster Care	19	14%
50/50 Joint	18	13%
Full Custody	17	12%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Knox	9	7%
Sevier	8	7%
Williamson	7	6%
Rutherford	7	6%
Shelby	6	5%
Blount	5	4%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	42	30%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	27	20%
Other	17	12%
High Conflict Divorce	11	8%
Other: (Short answer)	8	6%

05 PARENT VOICES — TENNESSEE

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Tennessee comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *CPS and the foster parents with the help of the judge and GAL took my 6 kids away. After three years of not seeing or talking to my children, they arrested me where I have been held in jail over a year and half awaiting a trial in 2027. They stated I. Their documents that there [...]*
>
> — ALISSA

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

I have had a ex parte restraining order against me for the last two months, even providing documentations where I do not do drugs, I have employment, I have a 4.0 in school. False accusations from ex-husband's attorney the judge keeps listening to. I am now forced to do the [...]

— TENNESSEE PARENT · COURTNEY

MORE VOICES FROM TENNESSEE

This has traumatized our family beyond repair. It has been so brutal and unexpected bc when you see this family together. You don't see just poverty and lack. You are huge love and that outshines any lack of money. These parents are not perfect. But they don't deserve to have [...]

— ALICIA

It has destroyed us my kids cry me and my husband no longer sleep we are depressed and we miss our children

— BRANDY

Our family is shattered. Our other children freeze when they see police or hear the word CPS. They believe that they are going to be taken.

— CASEY

Destroyed my motherly bond and role as the mother of my children. It has completely destroyed our family dynamics.

— JASMINE

The system failed to protect me and my children and corruptly stole them from me

— DAWN

Irreparable brain damage and trauma for my children as they were separated for more than 6 months from their protective parent—- job loss, reputation lost, parental rights

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Courts / GALs are biased and falsifying drug screens to take kids. One with the most money gets the child.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

They courts, DCS, and youth villages has violated our rights and have been working together actively to use false accusations to keep my fiance from getting custody of her 2 boys back and our 2 kids we have together.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Violated our constitutional rights ,took our children without due process

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Stole a year of my children's childhood and happiness - permanently damaged their confidence; violated and traumatized my entire family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Judge Woodruff failed to review exonerating evidence and made ruling based on false evidence.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I feel that my son was taken because DCS assumed we were drug addicts, and that we wouldn't know what they did and are doing is illegal. I feel that Knox Co. DCS and Juvenile Court are taking children from homes just to generate funds.

— WESLEY

The kanagaroo court they call family court has traumatized my children/myself as their mother in many ways. I PRAY for All the evil people that kidnapp children for profit & GOD IS GOOD ALL THE TIME...PRAY PRAY PRAY 🙌🙌🙌

— TIFFANY

It has destroyed our family and bond with our babies

— BRITTANY

They have stolen precious milestones that I could have done with my children and now I cannot get that back will ever get to do and I want to be in the life so bad they took everything for me

— LINDA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Broken us apart and drove a wedge between us. Increased mental health issues and falsely labeled us.*
>
> — KRISTINE

They have failed me and my children.

— AMBER

Harassed, fear mongered, threatened, belittled, falsely accused after several proofs of no wrong doing.

— CHRISTOPHER

Has torn us apart, this the only two grandkids in my family

— BRITTANY

I have lost everything as a full-time mother and wife to military soldier always deployed whether to three autistic children who needed daily therapies and treatments are removed from my home state kick out of my home with my children, gave up all my retirement and spousal [...]

— JESSICA

My family, as with countless others, have been victimized by a corrupt system based on equity, not law and not facts! Greed has lead to the "legal" kidnapping of hundreds of thousands of children nationwide, the destruction of the family unit, and a gross violation of our [...]

— STEPHENIE

This system has aided in the kidnapping and weaponization of my children.

— LAUREN

Completely isolated, my whole family the people they grew up, loving you and knowing and gave them to a woman who was practically a stranger all because I was concerned about my oldest son cystic fibrosis medication damaging his liver. I see them once a week now, but was [...]

— CYDNEE

Enabled coercive controlling behaviour and post separation abuse. Taken a child from a safe, protective mother and handed to an abuser.

— SELINA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Caused a traumatic family separation.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

Oldest is now grown and we have a good relationship. Other is 17 and has been completely alienated from dad because Judge Spitzer demanded a therapist recommendation and then refused to follow it. Therapist recommended kids be removed from mother's home due to severe gaslighting [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I went to the court trusting they would help my children and I. They have made it exponentially worse making me regret not fleeing instead.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Its destroyed my life, my families life my mothers life.. my sons life

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has failed me and my two children! You cannot put a price on your children, and you should not have to. Every mother and father deserve to be in their children's lives! Family court is broken! Judges need to be held accountable and not protected by the system and [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Taken my daughter away from her loving home because she spoke up about being abused. Caused irreparable psychological damage and more trauma to my daughter who already was fragile.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family courts believe "it takes two to tango. Not true. My ex-husband engaged in litigation abuse and the courts allowed it bc he is a lawyer. It was all about not paying the money, and punishing my children for "not choosing him." Sad.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My infant died and then DCS decided to take my other son on grounds of "substance abuse and unsafe sleep"

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They tried to destroy us but God had other plans. I, we are still struggling but the truth is coming out.

— CHAD

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Removing happy, athletic, well mannered kids from a stable, loving, mother & family while they are screaming, bawling, & threatening to run away and self harm should be considered child abuse itself.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

I've lost everything. And I'm still fighting for my child and I will never stop.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Hardin County Tennessee family court is like the mafia. Only the players win. The family, especially the children loses.

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it split me and my choldren up

— TABITHA

Annihilated . Robbed of love, time,memories,knowing . Divided, dismantled , Generational trauma

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The system has destroyed my brain, my sense of safety and trust. I have a hard time living on a daily basis. The courts enabled a domestic violence abuser to abuse me with courts by proxy. Take my innocent children away from an innocent mother who has been harassed, stalked [...]

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Destroy neglect and abuse

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Took the very thing that made my life worth being here for

— JEREMY

It has broken me. It’s taken my like away I’m no longer happy I’m depressed I hate life as sad as that is to say

— MEMORY

88 Tennessee parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 44 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — TENNESSEE

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Tennessee families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> CPS and the foster parents with the help of the judge and GAL took my 6 kids away. After three years of not seeing or talking to my children, they arrested me where I have been held in jail over a year and half awaiting a trial in 2027. They stated I. Their documents that there was no proof I was involved in anything but I “should have or could have” known something.
>
> — ALISSA

> This has traumatized our family beyond repair. It has been so brutal and unexpected bc when you see this family together. You don't see just poverty and lack. You are huge love and that outshines any lack of money. These parents are not perfect. But they don't deserve to have their 4 children kidnapped by DCS and now they was tontakentheotnpaeentsl rights away. I personally have never witnessed such abuse of power and corruption. At best it's criminal and these evil actors need to be held accountable for the consequences that are a direct result of their actions.
>
> — ALICIA

> It has destroyed us my kids cry me and my husband no longer sleep we are depressed and we miss our children
>
> — BRANDY

> I have had a ex parte restraining order against me for the last two months, even providing documentations where I do not do drugs, I have employment, I have a 4.0 in school. False accusations from ex-husband‘s attorney the judge keeps listening to. I am now forced to do the therapeutic counseling with my children since I’ve lost over 60 days of time with them due to the temporary restraining order.
>
> — COURTNEY

> Our family is shattered. Our other children freeze when they see police or hear the word CPS. They believe that they are going to be taken.
>
> — CASEY

> Destroyed my motherly bond and role as the mother of my children. It has completely destroyed our family dynamics.
>
> — JASMINE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

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— DAWN

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06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Has torn us apart, this the only two grandkids in my family
>
> — BRITTANY

> I have lost everything as a full-time mother and wife to military soldier always deployed whether to three autistic children who needed daily therapies and treatments are removed from my home state kick out of my home with my children, gave up all my retirement and spousal support and trade for my children's decisions that a year later were removed from me. My ex was over 20,000 in child support backpay. the judge did not care and now assigned me to pay him moral support than I can afford. I have zero contact now with my children. Now is their only caregiver. Their only parent their entire lies. I told my ex returned and stole them. I've been in jail. I've been living hell for five years.
>
> — JESSICA

> My family, as with countless others, have been victimized by a corrupt system based on equity, not law and not facts! Greed has lead to the "legal" kidnapping of hundreds of thousands of children nationwide, the destruction of the family unit, and a gross violation of our Constitutional Right to be together as a family. WE MUST FIGHT BACK, WE MUST DESTROY EVERY SYSTEM THAT HAS TAKEN PART, WE MUST HOLD ALL INVOLVED ACCOUNTABLE!!!!
>
> — STEPHENIE

> This system has aided in the kidnapping and weaponization of my children.
>
> — LAUREN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Completely isolated, my whole family the people they grew up, loving you and knowing and gave them to a woman who was practically a stranger all because I was concerned about my oldest son cystic fibrosis medication damaging his liver. I see them once a week now, but was completely isolated no contact without a court order For nearly 3 months. was pretty much forced to sign a stipulation that against my better judgment I done because it is supposed to get my children back soon. I saw the judge in February was ordered to give him the medication so I did except I missed three evening doses due to him, falling asleep. The caseworker came in took pictures so there's proof only three doses were missed. Told me she would be taking my children not that day, but she would be taking them. She did less than a month later and told me she would have them for no less than three months that was seven months ago. Dcs closed my case without ever going to court this time. They told lies they broke me, their dad my mom & dad my nieces & nephew's my sister & my grandparents, their sisters, which I still have shared custody of most of all they broke my children we have to all stand up and cry out in one united voice NO MORE STEALING OUR CHILDREN We have to be heard

— CYDNEE

Enabled coercive controlling behaviour and post separation abuse. Taken a child from a safe, protective mother and handed to an abuser.

— SELINA

Caused a traumatic family separation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Oldest is now grown and we have a good relationship. Other is 17 and has been completely alienated from dad because Judge Spitzer demanded a therapist recommendation and then refused to follow it. Therapist recommended kids be removed from mother’s home due to severe gaslighting and psychological abuse. He removed oldest and left the youngest at 50/50 and this caused the alienation. Dad no longer sees or talks to youngest (17) due to alienation (child is not allowed to have a phone or visit dad).

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Its destroyed my life, my families life my mothers life.. my sons life
>
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> The system has failed me and my two children! You cannot put a price on your children, and you should not have to. Every mother and father deserve to be in their children's lives! Family court is broken! Judges need to be held accountable and not protected by the system and allowed to do whatever they want. Because of false allegations that were never proven to be true,I have had to go the past four years with not getting to see my children the way that I should have and I still have three more years to go with my son. I will do whatever it takes to help change what goes on in family court anyway that I can because it has affected me so greatly.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Taken my daughter away from her loving home because she spoke up about being abused. Caused irreparable psychological damage and more trauma to my daughter who already was fragile.
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it split me and my choldren up

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Annihilated . Robbed of love, time,memories,knowing . Divided, dismantled , Generational trauma

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has destroyed my brain, my sense of safety and trust. I have a hard time living on a daily basis. The courts enabled a domestic violence abuser to abuse me with courts by proxy. Take my innocent children away from an innocent mother who has been harassed, stalked, etc. my children are below the age of 12, and have known of what family court is since my youngest was around the age of 4 or 5.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroy neglect and abuse

— HOLLY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Took the very thing that made my life worth being here for

— JEREMY

It has broken me. It's taken my like away I'm no longer happy I'm depressed I hate life as sad as that is to say

— MEMORY

Words can't begin to describe the pain and all emotions etc. CPS kidnapped/stole my babygirl Sept. 12,2024.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Violated our due process and refused to apply domestic violence provisions of UCCJEA. they have painted me as crazy and unstable and have separated me from my daughter from 2/3 if her life so far. they allowed the father's misrepresentations and documented abuse go unaddressed and are continuing on with trial and i have no contact with my baby since october 2025.

— MEKAH

It cost us everything but most importantly my children!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Every time I've been in courtroom I was in there I was accused of what I did and I took my time and I laid down and nobody has ever tried to get over on me allowing me or anything this time is totally different it made me not trust the system no more I don't believe in it it's horrible I believe all these things that people say about it it's it's messed up man cuz I know for a fact I've done nothing wrong I would never in my life for my kids and I did a emergency removal of my kids for missing days to school and lied on the paperwork if you look at my paperwork you can tell where it is some somebody's doing something messed up on my on my paperwork dude like I just it's messed up and I have no no way taking care of this it's like they say that I'm guilty and I have to pay all this money to prove my innocence and it's crazy man because it's involving my kids and I'm really I'm losing my mind I don't know what to do

— MICHAEL

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It took my family away,forced my son to stay with his rapists,took my jobs and prevented me from going to school, work, or have a business. I was put in jail on false allegations,had my bond revoked and doubled twice and after I had a property bond I was put in jail for child support, even though I was paid up current. Effectively preventing me from being able to represent myself properly and the " elbow counsel" refused to send out subpoenas or anything else. This format is unable to allow me to write out twenty five years of being terrorized by these people. I have a four drawer file cabinet full of stuff.. I've had "advocates" from the battered womens shelter fired for harassing me after court,only for her to get hired in the clerks office. Iam currently facing willful contempt charges for being unable to work. All my children are grown,but I am going to jail if " the State" doesn't get that money.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has almost broke me financially it has almost broke me mentally and it has taken away a bond that never should have been broken.

— WILLIAM

Separated my totally dependent son from me. It cost me thousands of dollars and isolation and intimidation.

— DEBRA

It has completely upended my ability to be a present father; it’s impossible to get fair representation when one side is a millionaire.

— ELLIOT

They are trying to destroy the only little family we have

— JADA

Broke my bond I had to earn from my kids from birth over lies then blame me when I get mad .I don't think so freedom of speech is a god given right I don't sit quiet when it comes to the government law judges or anything .they don't own me or my mouth or my kids .I'll scream that to top of my lungs everywhere. I'm broke so let them try to sue me for slander it ain't slander If it's true .and I go by a code of if u slander me expect it back point blank period .like Kendrick said don't tell no lies about me and I won't tell no truth about you ..

— KAMIKA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I went into family court trying to protect my children, present serious concerns, and maintain stability, but I felt unheard while the outcome gave equal parenting time and left important safety, communication, child support, and property issues unresolved.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Panic disorder for me, son hurt himself many times, he overworked my son with excessive exercise

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I've lost my boys because of the financial abuse but my ex-husband, through the system. No one to help me. I lost my home now, everything. Just don't know how to keep going anymore.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Taken in sept 2025. Constant continuances and court costs. They all lie about everything and refuse to give me documents which are my right by law. Do not follow TCA codes but yet spit them back in my face when convenient for them to do so. The judge is biased and rules on his opinions instead of following the state laws and statutes. Has move my grandson over 300 miles away without said notice,objection,or court hearing for a order. Has not done a comparative testing for the false fentinyl allegation results for respiradone use.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Kidnapped my child across state lines on false allegations with bad signatures and notarization on petitions based on events that took place 3+ years ago and/or in another state. 3 states total.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system pretty much broke up my family after their mother got deported. Also since then my mental health hasn't been the same.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system has made me feel like I'm a bad parent because I only make minimum wage and live paycheck to paycheck

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have lied about the safety of my children and puts my children with their father who has a restricted license and 2 DUI's, calling him a "better fit parent". Alienated me from my daughter for 2 years, and revoked my primary custody right because I refuse to live in a state with my abuser and my daughter is considered property of the state because she is "born there as a citizen."

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The fake judicial system has ROBBED me of my children and his attorney has willingly corroborated w my ex to keep my children from their GOOD, LOVING Mother. It has nearly cost me my life! I have a text message from my Ex alluding, very manipulatively, that he would push me to suicide and he would have NO REMORSE!! End qout!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Due Process is a joke in Williamson County. the Court works directly for DCS and a pro se parent has a huge battle to stay afloat.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My daughter was kidnapped from me, based on a false accusation that was never investigated prior to action. I have extensive evidence proving my innocence but not enough money to continue fighting for much longer. My daughter never feared me, until she was told to fear me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took a kid that never should've been taken now I had to live with the fact that I don't know if my baby is gonna remember me or even be OK

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Lawrence County Juvenile Court has caused severe emotional distress to my family, and that worsened after my children's father passed away. It become so severe that I had to take my son (13 at the time) to a psychiatric hospital for help due to SI.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has removed the ONLY person that has been in their lives constantly EVERY DAY for their entire lives since birth and they are aggressively insisting that "it WIL BE reported that dad refused to comply with a drug test and that will result in removal.

— KAMERYN

Given my child back to the abuser without some form of intervention or accountability on my spouses part. He continues to lie and then gets rewarded for it.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

His modification for full custody action arose only after a child support review and reflects retaliation, not a genuine concern for the child’s welfare and police family connections and abuse of authority from law enforcement.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Separated me, the primary care taker and homeschooling/stay at home mother from my children due to allegations on a possible move and a text message I sent to my daughter telling her the truth and use her voice. They are silencing me and only justifying the allegations instead of the true evidence I have supplied them with

— COURTNEY

There is no good reason o should not be allowed in my children’s lives. They want thier mother and the system took that from them with absolutely no good reason. I have always been a fit parent.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Living in a DV shelter didn't help my case. My abuser continues to emotionally abuse me through the court system by taking them away in a passive aggressive manner.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The trauma is unlike anything I've ever experienced. I had to get on situational anxiety meds, I didnt sleep, lost weight and was in a bad place. Knowing our state has a lawsuit against DCS for ABUSE of chidlren with disabilities and that we already had years of inadequate ADA access with NO help anywhere made it so much worst!
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> They hold her hostage despite her begging and pleading for money. That's all they ever care about is if I'm paying money, even when my at the time 9 year old writes them a letter begging for help.
>
> — JULIE

> Created their worst enemy.
>
> — JESSICA

> Blount County Juvenile court is breaking mandatory reporting laws. I refuse to sign any gag order until I get some answers and the damage isn't over when the case ends.
>
> — AMANDA

> The unethical OC and Psych evaluator with zero no credible experience of PA Negatively impacted my sons and myself, while never holding the Alienating Parent responsible..
>
> — JENA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system has allowed my covert narcissist ex to continue to abuse me and our child by allowing him to intentionally harming our child, corrersive control me, financially destroy me and my family, all for the sake of parental fairness instead of child's best interest. The lack of accountability has allowed him to violate court orders giving him full rein and enabled him to continue to abuse our child regularly as well as me... which was the entire reason I left him in the first place!

— ANGELA

Gender discrimination

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Made me public school my 2

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court process moves at the speed of procedure, but childhood moves at the speed of time. While hearings, appeals, and delays continue, my son and I are the ones paying the price—through distance, missed moments, impeded communication, and a relationship that requires thousands of miles and thousands of dollars just to preserve. I have spent over six years being a stay at home mother and over $18,000 fighting simply to remain in his life after the judge awarded primary custody to the father last year.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has destroyed all three of our lives. I have extreme panic attacks, my son is ten and in therapy and has extreme anxiety, he has trust issues, separation anxiety he will never live a normal healthy life the system has destroyed any chance of that then they wonder why people have mental breakdowns and freak out

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I have been alienated from my children from the last eight years. My youngest has tried to commit suicide twice because of this situation she has been in state custody twice because of the situation I'm forced to pay almost $1300 every two weeks in child support, I asked for a modification over a year ago. I had just been furloughed from my job. Didn't have a job. They still increased my child support.. They took over $11,000 in income tax in 2026. They have made it impossible to survive. I have a court date in June they have an oddly attachment on me and want to lock me up because of child support this whole case needs dismissed!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The sexual abuse case against my stepdaughter put a wedge in my family that we never got over but it's year after year medical neglect physical abuse educational neglect I'm on drugs got to take mental evaluations so it's really put a wedge in between how I raise my child I'm dictated by the system on how I raise my child

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This has caused my family mental distress, homelessness. And separated my child from the only person who has been a constant in his life. He is now bullied in school and told things have been done to him that haven't we are missing the most precious time in his development and was stuck in a house watching my granny die the whole time. Then told to keep it from me.

— FELICIA

My ex has played the system she has canceled mediation now 5 times been thru 3 different lawyers. Says I can have her anytime I want I have asked hundreds of times and always a no. Ive offered to watch her on holidays. To be told I didnt tell her I was off that day. I only get extra time when its convenient for her.

— JESSE

Despite completing my case plan, maintaining my sobriety, passing drug screens, and being found safe to parent my newborn by another Tennessee DCS investigation, the system continues to keep my son from me without clear justification. This ongoing separation has caused severe emotional harm to both me and my family and has made me feel trapped in an inconsistent system where reunification keeps being delayed despite my compliance and progress.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

88 full approved Tennessee comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Tennessee report comes from Tennessee respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Tennessee — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 138 Tennessee families reporting here are not the universe of Tennessee families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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